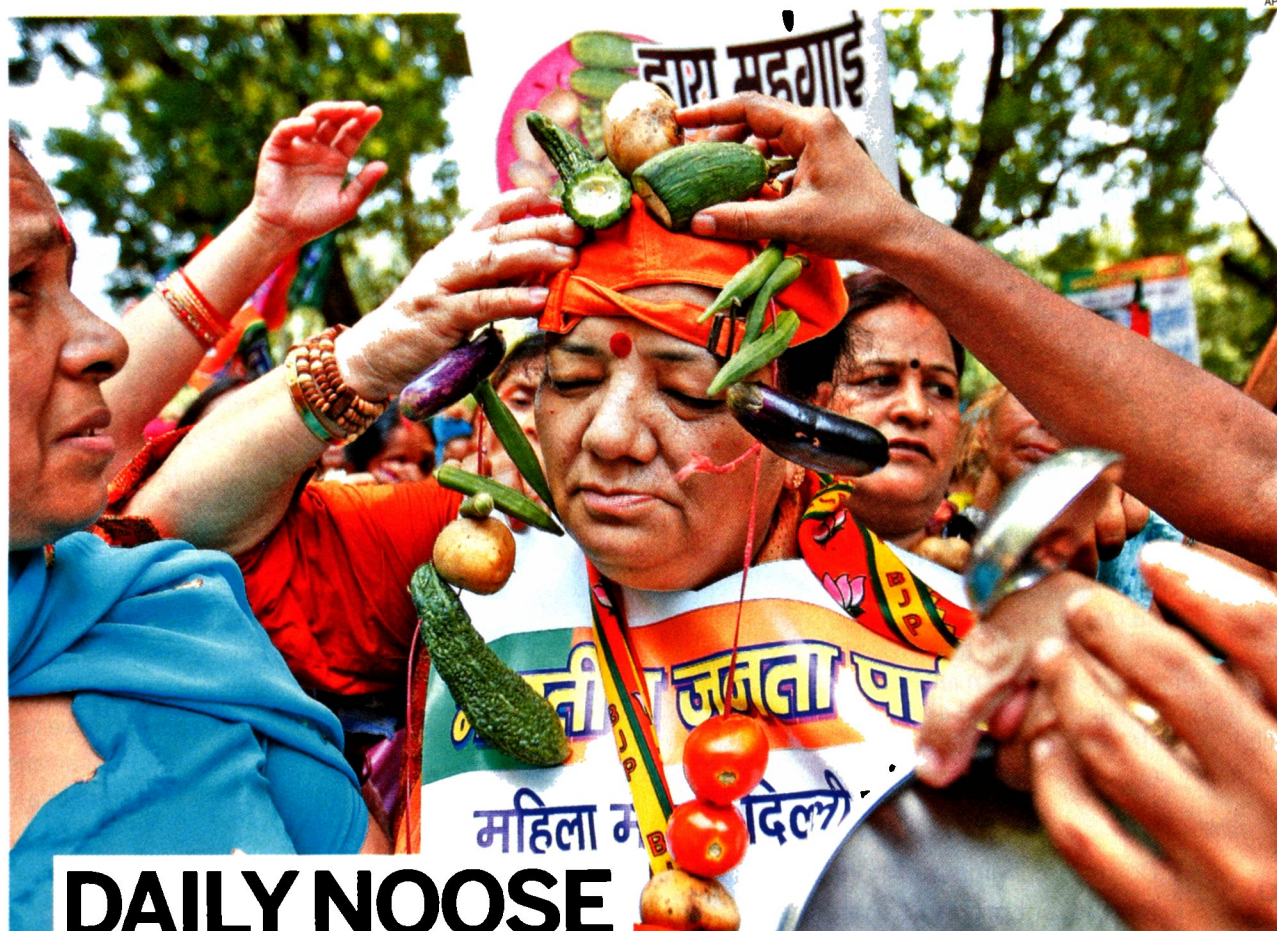




DAILY NOOSE

A WOMAN wears a garland of vegetables during a demonstration against inflation in Delhi. Prices of essential commodities have headed north after the Lok Sabha polls, making the middle class take to the streets in protest.

DELHI | Memorial Hole

It is meant to be a memorial for the nation's war dead but seems to be more of a monument to India's slothful bureaucracy. The army has wanted a memorial inscribed with names of nearly 50,000 soldiers killed in four major wars since Independence. The British-built India Gate has the names of fallen soldiers from the two World Wars who served in a colonial army. Free India's National War Memorial proposal has been put through various ministerial hoops for a decade now. The first objection was that the memorial would block the view of India Gate. The Ministry of Defence responded by saying that the memorial would have martyrs' names inscribed on marble slabs in the ground below eye level. Now the Ministry of Urban Development has reservations on the project due to "certain statutory clearances and availability of land". Never a shortage of feeble excuses when it comes to honouring India's war dead.

by Sandeep Unnithan

AN ARTIST'S IMPRESSION OF THE MEMORIAL



BUREAUCRATIC RED-TAPE CONTINUES TO STALL THE CONSTRUCTION OF A NATIONAL WAR MEMORIAL